

LECTURE 05

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ



SS-1002
Islamic & Religious Studies

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**The Sciences of
Quran
{Uloom ul Quran
(علوم القرآن)}**

INTRODUCTION

By 'science' here we don't mean natural sciences such as physics and chemistry.

The 'science' here is an expression for methodological study and certain techniques for the understanding of the Quran.

The Sciences of the Quran therefore are preliminary studies that are necessary to enable the correct understanding of the Quran. The sciences of the abrogating and abrogated Ayaat, the clear and the unclear Ayaat and the occasions of the revelation, etc. are some examples of the sciences of the Quran.

DEFINITIONS

The knowledge of *'Ulloom Al-Qur'ân*, or '**The Sciences of the Qur'ân**', deals with the knowledge of those sciences that have a direct bearing on the recitation, history, understanding and implementation of the Qur'ân. It is, therefore, a vast field of Islamic scholarship

OR

Topics relating to the Quran in terms of how it was revealed; its order of revelation; how it was gathered; how it is to be written, recited, and explained; its miraculousness; what verses are abrogated, defending against doubts about the Quran, and other such Quran-related topics

ULOOM UL QURAN

Denotes studies concerned with:

1. Quran's Revelation

التنزيل

2. Its collection

جمع القرآن

3. Its order and
arrangement

ترتيب انزول

4. Its writing

رسم القرآن

5. Information about
the reasons and
occasions of revelation

اسباب النزول

About what was
revealed in Mecca and
what in Medina

المكى و المدنى

About the abrogating
and abrogated verses

الناسخ و منسوخ

About the clear and
the unclear verses

المحكمات و المتشابهات

The science of
pronunciation

التجويد

The different
methodologies of
reciting the *Qur'an*
القرآت

The knowledge of the
various forms
حروف

The knowledge of the
various classifications of
its verses
'*am* and '*has*, '*mutlaq* and
'*muqqayad*

The knowledge of its
interpretation
تفسير

The grammatical analysis
of the *Qur'an*
اعراب القرآن

The knowledge of those
words whose usage has
become uncommon over
time

الغرائب القرآن

'The Procedure and
Methodology of
Interpretation'

علم اصول تفسير

Benefits of Studying Uloom ul Quran



Firstly

It enables the reader to realize the wealth of knowledge and insight that exists with regards to the Book of Allah



Secondly

It enables the student of knowledge to better understand the *Qur'an*, in that he will be familiar with the history of its revelation and collection, and the various aspects that aids its comprehension.



Thirdly

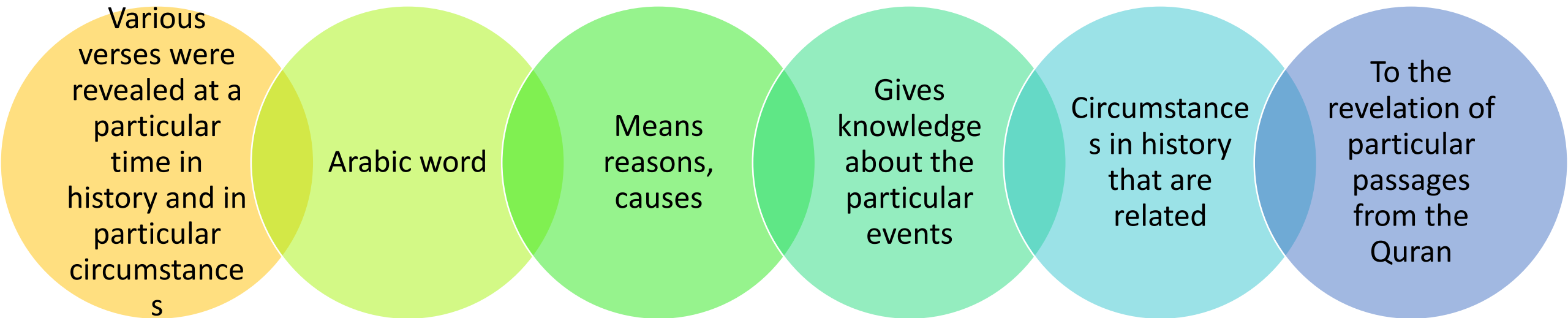
It increase a person's belief (*iman*), because he will realize the beauty of the *Qur'an* and the great blessings that he has been given through its revelation



Fourthly

He will be able to defend the *Qur'an* against his enemies, since he will be equipped with the true and pristine knowledge of the *Qur'an*, unadulterated by the prejudices of its opponents.

ASBAB AL NUZUL (اسباب النزول)



I'JAZ UL QURAN (اعجاز القرآن)

Arabic word

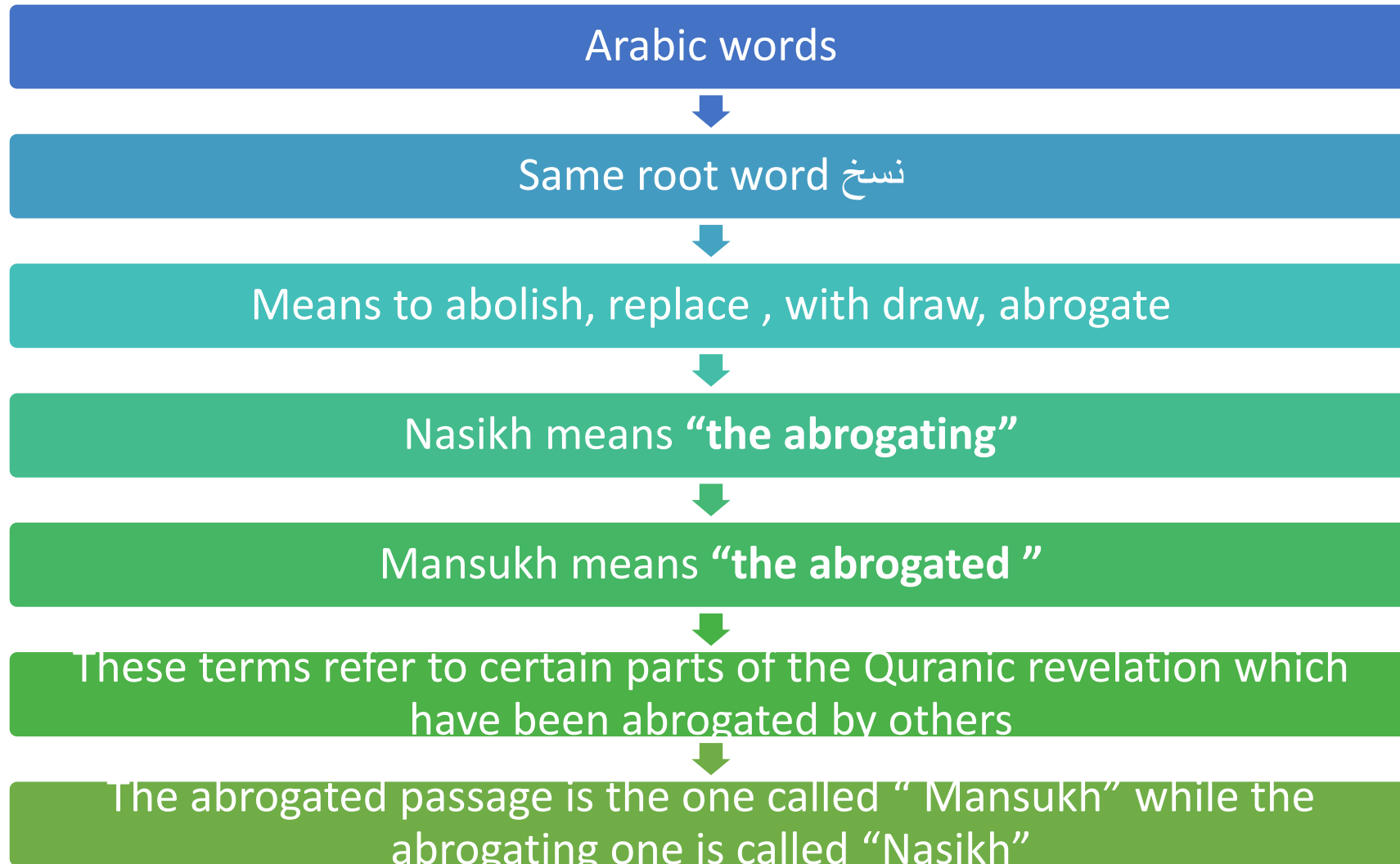
Means miracle, inimitable

So I'jazul Quran means “ inimitability of Quran

Means Quran is the belief that no human word or speech can match Quran in its content or form and proving the Quran as solely the word of Allah given to the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H)

ABROGATING AND ABROGATED VERSES

(الناسخ و منسوخ)



MAKKI AND MADANI REVELATION

(المكي والمدني)



Is it a Makki or Madani verse?

The Quran was revealed to the Prophet (as) over 23 years, mainly in the Holy cities of Makka and Madina, however, it is the Prophet's migration from Mecca to Medina which determines whether the verse is Makki/Madani.



Key feature of Meccan Verses:

The concepts
of Allah and
Tawhid

Man's return
to Allah for
judgement.

Gratitude and
worship

The position
of the poor

Muhammad's
position and
call

Key feature of Medinan Verses:

Further
development
of the
concepts of
Allah and
Tawhid

Man's
dependence
on Allah

The
obligations
of worship
and Muslim
life

The
organization
of the
community

MUHKAMAT AND MUTASHABIHAT

(المحكمات و المتشبهات)

Muhkamat

Something of which
knowledge was
desired

Something with only
one dimension

Something sufficient
in meaning ,
requiring no further

Mutashabihat

Something known to
Allah only

Something with more
than one dimension

Something requiring
further explanation

Allah says in surah Al Imran verse no 07

هُوَ الَّذِي أَنْزَلَ عَلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ مِنْهُ آيَاتٌ مُحْكَمَاتٌ هُنَّ أُمُّ الْكِتَابِ وَأُخَرُ مُتَشَابِهَاتٌ

- He it is Who has sent down to thee the Book: In it are verses basic or fundamental (of established meaning); they are the foundation of the Book: others are allegorical.

GENERAL AND SPECIFIC

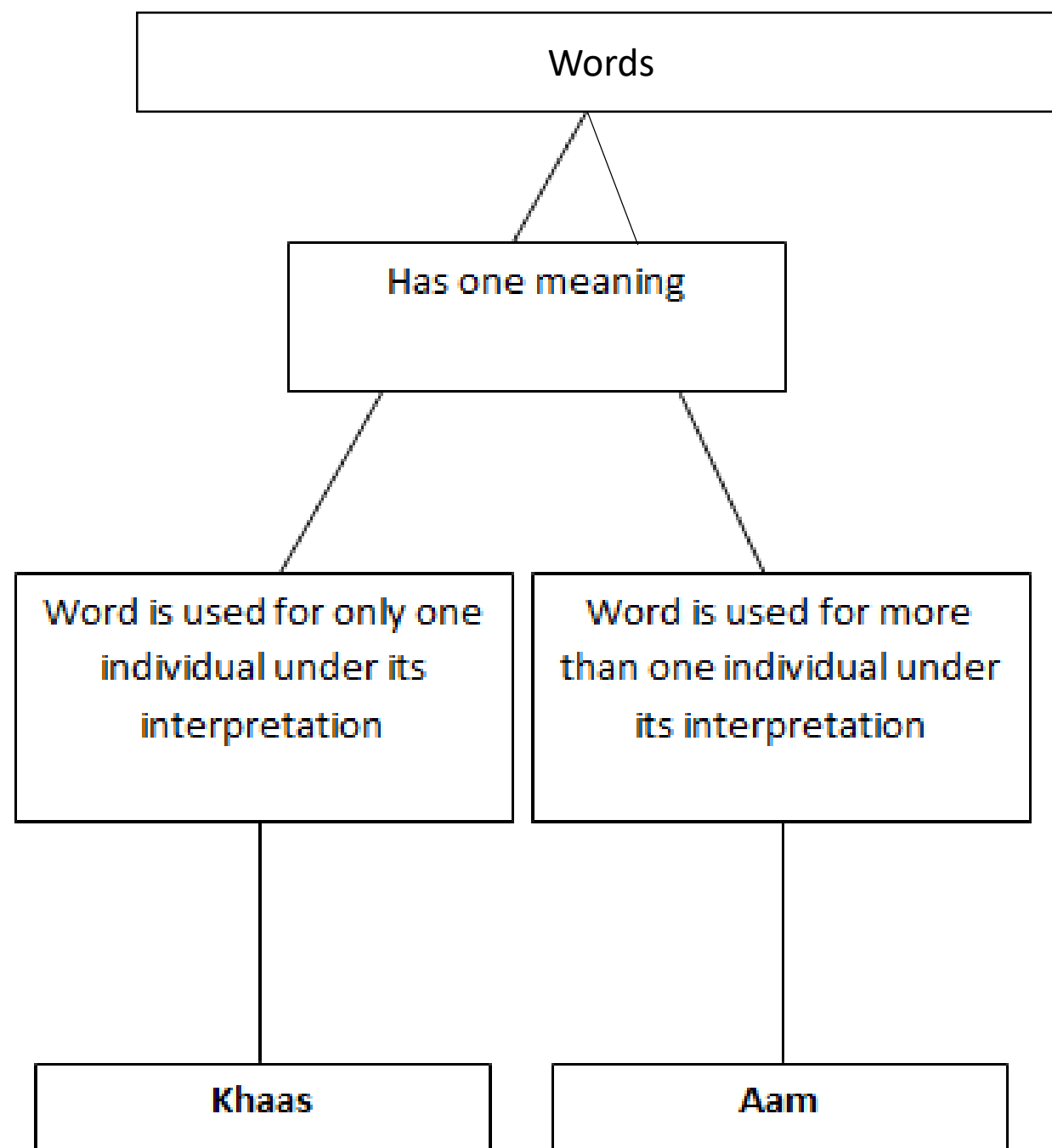
(عام و خاص)

'Aam (lit.
'general')

- It is a word that applies to all the members of a specific set, no matter how small or large that set is.
- For example, Allah says:
- **"Every soul shall taste death."** ([Q3 \[Aal-Imraan\]: 185](#))
- This verse is applicable to every soul, be it human, animal or jinn.

Khaas (lit.
'specific')

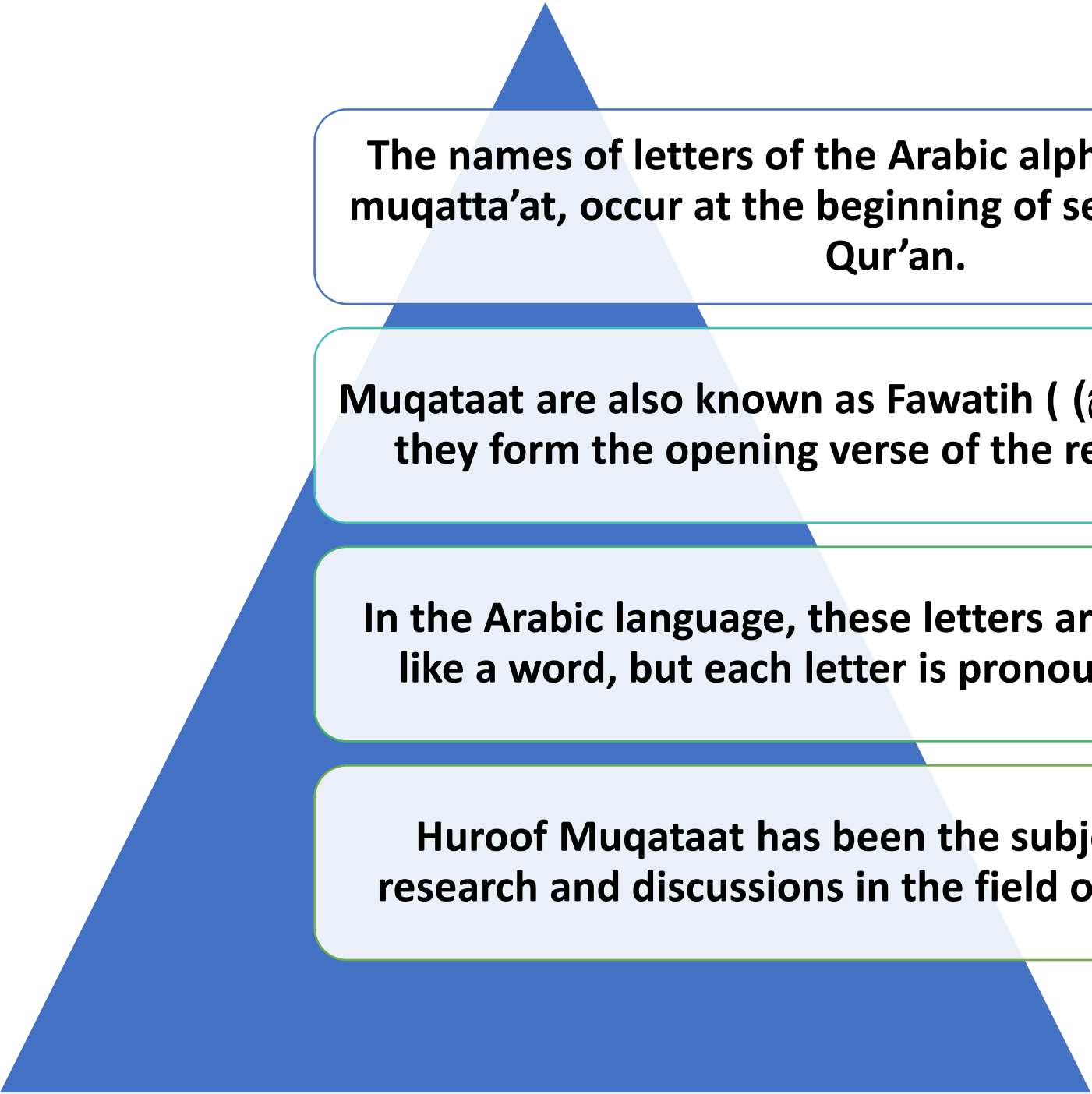
- It is a word that is used to denote a limited number of things, including everything to which it can be applied.
- *Khaas* applies to a single subject or a specified number of objects



HUROOF AL-MUQATTA'AT: DISJOINTED LETTERS

(حروف المقطعات)





The names of letters of the Arabic alphabet, called huruf muqatta'at, occur at the beginning of several surahs of the Qur'an.

Muqataat are also known as Fawatih (فواتح) or “openers” as they form the opening verse of the respective Surahs.

In the Arabic language, these letters are written together like a word, but each letter is pronounced separately.

Huroof Muqataat has been the subject of extensive research and discussions in the field of Quranic studies.

THE ARRANGEMENT OF HOLY QURAN OR THE QURANIC ORDER

Tauqifee (توقیفی)

- The order of the Holy Quran given by the Holy Prophet (PBUH)

Nuzooli (نزولی)

- The order in respect of revelation.

IMPORTANT NOTE

The holy Quran was recorded only according to Tarteef-e- Tauqifee not Nuzooli. Because the compilation is according to law-e-Mhfooz while the revelation is according to the circumstances

TAFSIR (التفسير)

Arabic word

Means, “explanation,” “exegesis”

the “**Tafsir Quran**” can be defined as this Quranic and Islamic science that provides translation, explanation, interpretation, or commentary to the Quranic verses to better understand the Quran.

Quran Tafsir utilizes a compilation of other sciences such as linguistics, fiqh, hadith, and theology to provide a detailed explanation, translation, and clear understanding of Allah’s (SWT) words and message.

KINDS OF TAFSIR

Tafsir bi-l-ma'thur

- By this is meant all explanations of the Qur'an which can be traced back through a chain of transmission to a sound source, i.e.:
- 1. The Qur'an itself.
- 2. The explanation of the Prophet.
- 3. The explanation by Companions of the Prophet (to some extent).
- 4. The explanation by Successors (to some extent)

Tafsir bi'l-ra'y

- It is not based directly on transmission of knowledge by the predecessors, but on the use of reason and ijtihad.
- Tafsir bi'l-ra'y does not mean 'interpretation by mere opinion', but deriving an opinion through ijtihad based on sound sources

The Collection of Quran
الجمع القرآن

It has various meanings

1. To learn the Quran by heart.

2. To write down every revelation.

To bring together those materials upon which the Quran has been written.

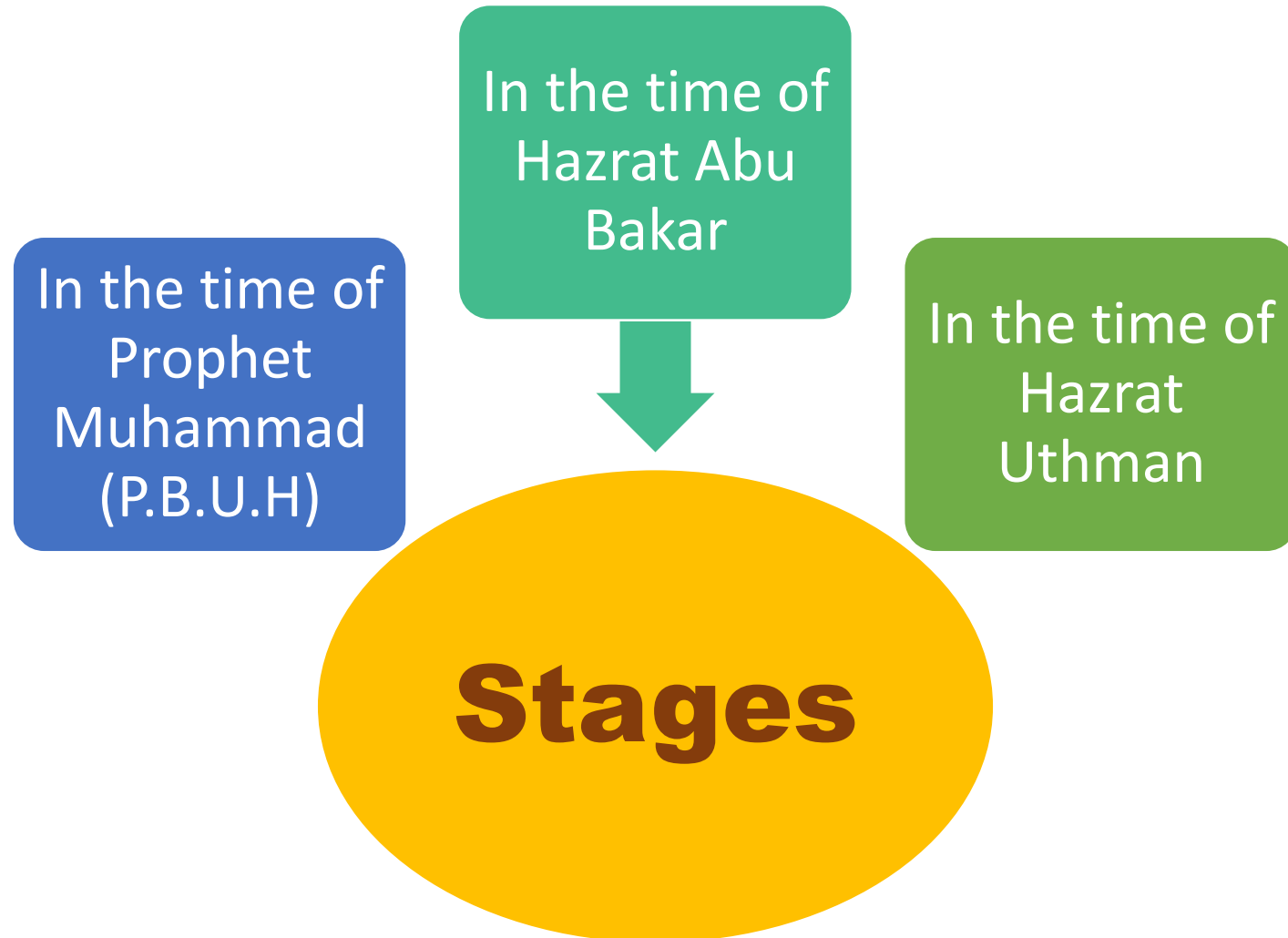
To bring together the reports of people who have memorized the Quran.

To bring together all such sources, both oral and written.

WHY WAS NO BOOK LEFT BY THE HOLY PROPHET (P.B.U.H)?



STAGES OF COLLECTION



1. During the life of the Prophet (s.a.w) (570-632 CE).

- The whole Quran was revealed during this time but it was also present in the written form.
- There is ample evidence showing that the entire Qur'an was written down in the Prophets (saw) lifetime.
- As stated earlier whenever any verse was revealed by Allah, he would instruct scribes to record the revelation on parchments of paper or pieces of leather.
- He would also indicate in which Surah each ayah was to be placed.
- Hazrat Zaid bin Thabbit was one of the most prominent of the scribes and has reported that he, along with other companions would compile the Quran in the presence of the Prophet.
- During this time the names of the Surahs were also known.
- Apart from that Angel Gabriel would also come to the Holy Prophet (saw) every Ramadan to listen to him reciting the Qur'an, and listened to him twice in the year of his demise.
- Each verse received was recited by him and its location relative to other verses and Surahs was identified by him.

2. Compilation During the Reign of Abu Bakar

- At this time after the Battle of Yamamah, there were only a very few left who had memorized the Quran.
- As a result, Sayidina Umar bin Kattab became concerned and anxious that if the situation continues or worsens, a large portion of the Holy Quran could be lost.
- With this he suggested to the caliph at that time to start compiling the Quran in to a proper book.
- At first Abu Bakar disagreed with him as he said he could not do anything like that as the Holy Prophet did not compile the Quran during his lifetime.
- However, after persuasion from Umar bin Khattab he agreed and ordered the compilation of the Quran in the form of the book.
- Hazrat Zaid bin Thabbit was assigned to collect and compile the Qur'an into one volume, he was who was also astonished at this request and declared it would have been easier for him to shift a mountain than to do such a task. Hazrat Zaid bin Thabbit collected all the written parts of the Qur'an from date leaves, parchment and pieces of leather and also listened to many of the hafiz who recited verses from their memories.
- He compiled the written Qur'an into one single volume. Then, Sayyidina Abu Bakr became its official custodian, passing on to Sayidina Umar bin Khattab during his caliphate.
- After his demise the Qur'anic volume was passed into the custody of his daughter Hazrat Hafsa.

COMPILATION CRITERIA USED BY ZAYD BIN THABIT

The task assigned to Zayd ibn Thabit was to collect the portions scattered with different people, verify the texts and put them in the order assigned to the verses and chapters by the Prophet Muhammad himself before his death. Though Zayd (the head of the committee) himself knew the whole Qur'an by heart, along with many others, he followed a very meticulous procedure in its compilation.

Following is a brief description:

1. Everyone who knew a portion of the Qur'an came and reported it to be written by the committee. However, the report was not accepted unless it was heard by the reporting companion directly from the mouth of the Prophet himself, and the text was checked with the Prophet in his last year of life

2. The verses and chapters of the text were written in the order assigned to them by the Prophet.

3. In order to ensure authenticity, no text was accepted unless the person who reported it to the committee brought two witnesses who saw him hear the verses directly from the blessed Prophet's mouth.

Through the above meticulous procedure the committee, which was headed by Zayd ibn Thabit aided by `Umar ibn Al-Khattab, collected the whole text of the Qur'an, which was then preserved and kept by the Caliph Abu Bakr.

3. During the caliphate of Uthman (644-656 CE)

- The expansion of Islam territory was large. It expanded to lands where no one knows the Arabic language because they were not Arabic.
- Because of this the problems of dialects started to get common.
- Different people had different accents and styles in pronunciation which led to conflict because people were blaming each other saying the other was reading the Quran wrong.
- When the caliph Uthman came to know about this he feared that the conflict might become more serious.
- So the caliph asked Hazrat Hafsa for the original volume of the Quran promising to return it to her once copies were made.
- She sent it immediately to him and Hazrat Zaid bin Thabit, who was responsible for the first compilation was appointed as the head of a committee to make exact copies of the original.
- Finally, the Quraish accent was appointed to be used by Muslims all around the world.
- It is because the Holy Quran was revealed in the Quraish accent.
- These copies were sent to all the provinces of the Islamic states. It was ordered to burn all other copies of the Quran or replace

Why The Caliphs Felt A Need To Compile The Quran:

Abu Bakr:

- Many memorizers were killed in the battle of Yamama.
- Thus, he felt that Quran can't be kept in memories alone.
- Although prophet hadn't made a written compilation of the Quran, he realized that this needs to be done in order to preserve the authentic Quran.

Usman:

- If different versions were allowed to exist the original meaning might no longer survive.
- Muslims wouldn't have a single source of supply.
- Rival interpretation might break the unity of the community as only the original revelation given to the prophet could preserve unity.



Allah began the
revelation at
the Cave of Hira



The whole revelation
of the Quran
took 23 years



In the early
years, Muslims
memorized it



Some wrote it
down on bones
and leaves

The Compilation Of The Holy Quran



Many huffaz
died during the
Battle of Yamama



Umar (RA)
proposed compiling
the Quran



Zaid bin Thabit
headed the
compilation task



Uthman (RA) made
copies of the
compilation

Transmission of the Qur'an

